

Daily Macros

Based on your profile: 30F · 5ft · 61kg · PCOS (insulin resistance) · Anemia · light to moderate activity. Targets are calibrated for blood sugar stability, anemia recovery, and gentle weight management toward ~56kg. Your eating window is 9:20am–12:15am (~15 hrs) — aim to front-load most calories before 8pm.

Daily totals

CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBS (LOW GI)	HEALTHY FATS	IRON
1650	85–95	160–180	50–60	25–30
kcal / day	g/day · 1.4g/kg	g / day	g / day	mg/day (anemia)

Per meal targets

BREAKFAST · 9:20 AM	LUNCH · 1:30 PM — BIGGEST MEAL	DINNER AT WORK · 7:30 PM — LIGHTER
Calories350–420 kcal	Calories500–580 kcal	Calories380–450 kcal
Protein20–25 g	Protein25–30 g	Protein20–25 g
Carbs (low GI)35–45 g	Carbs (low GI)55–65 g	Carbs (low GI)35–45 g
Healthy fats12–15 g	Healthy fats15–20 g	Healthy fats12–15 g
Iron6–8 mg	Iron8–12 mg	Iron5–7 mg
Fibre6–8 g	Fibre8–10 g	Fibre5–7 g
Vitamin C (for iron)30–40 mg	Vitamin C (for iron)40–60 mg	Vitamin C (for iron)20–30 mg

Snack targets · 5:30 pm at work

Calories	Protein	Carbs	Fats	GI rule
150–200	8–12 g	15–20 g	6–8 g	Always low GI
kcal				

PCOS macro rules: Never eat carbs alone — always pair with protein or fat. Eat protein within 30 min of waking. Carbs should always come from whole grains, millets, legumes, or vegetables — never refined. No sugary drinks. Limit total carbs to 40g per sitting to prevent insulin spikes. Fibre at every meal slows glucose release.

Breakfast Options

All breakfasts are designed to hit 20–25g protein, 35–45g low-GI carbs, 6–8mg iron. Schedule A days (strength training): use options 1, 2, 3 as the post-workout full meal. Schedule B days: any option works. Festival days (no eggs): options 5, 6, 7.

OPTION 1

All phases · everyday base

Ragi overnight oats power bowl

½ cup rolled oats + 1 tbsp ragi flour · soaked overnight in water or diluted yogurt

Morning: 1 tbsp sesame seeds + 1 tsp jaggery + amla powder + 2 boiled eggs on the side

Protein ~24g

Carbs ~38g

Fat ~14g

Iron ~7mg

Vit C: amla

OPTION 2

All phases · high protein

Pesarattu + egg bhurji

2 green moong dosas (pesarattu) with ginger-green chutney + 2-egg bhurji with onion, tomato, turmeric, cumin + small amla or guava alongside

Protein ~26g

Carbs ~36g

Fat ~13g

Iron ~7.5mg

Vit C: tomato+amla

OPTION 3

All phases · gut health

Ragi idli + sambar + eggs

3 ragi idlis with vegetable sambar (drumstick, tomato) + coconut chutney (1 tbsp) + 2 boiled or poached eggs

+ 1 glass amla juice

Protein ~25g

Carbs ~40g

Fat ~12g

Iron ~8mg

Vit C: amla juice

OPTION 4

Luteal phase · magnesium-rich

Oats upma + 2-egg omelette

½ cup oats cooked as upma with mustard, curry leaves, onion, carrot, peas

+ 2-egg spinach-tomato omelette

+ pumpkin seeds sprinkled on top (magnesium)

Protein ~25g

Carbs ~37g

Fat ~15g

Iron ~7mg

OPTION 5

Menstruation · iron focus · no egg

Ragi porridge + sprouted moong bowl

1 cup ragi kanji with jaggery (5g) + sesame seeds + flaxseed + 1 cup sprouted green moong with lemon, salt, cumin + 1 glass fresh amla or tomato juice

Protein ~20g

Carbs ~42g

Fat ~10g

Iron ~9mg

Vit C: amla+lemon

OPTION 6

Follicular · light · festival

Tofu scramble + jowar dosa

100g firm tofu scrambled with turmeric, cumin, pepper, onion, capsicum

+ 2 jowar dosas with tomato chutney

+ 1 tbsp nutritional yeast stirred into tofu (B12)

Protein ~22g

Carbs ~38g

Fat ~11g

Iron ~6.5mg

OPTION 7

All phases · quickest prep

Boiled eggs + ragi ladoo + fruit

- 2 boiled eggs (prepped night before)
- + 2 ragi-sesame-jaggery ladoos (batch-made Sunday)
- + 1 guava or apple
- + 6 soaked almonds

Protein ~21g

Carbs ~36g

Fat ~15g

Iron ~7mg

Vit C: guava

Lunch Options

Lunch is your biggest meal — 500–580 kcal, 25–30g protein. Always include: a millet or brown rice base + protein dal/legume + iron-rich sabzi + 1 tsp ghee tadka + yogurt. Yogurt is best eaten at the end or separately (calcium slightly competes with iron). Pair with Vit C: tomato, lemon, tamarind.

OPTION 1

Menstruation · maximum iron

Ragi sangati + palak pappu + drumstick sambar

1 cup ragi sangati (ragi flour cooked thick)
+ palak pappu (spinach dal with ghee tadka + cumin)
+ drumstick sambar with tomato
+ 1 boiled egg on the side · yogurt after meal

Protein ~28g

Carbs ~58g

Fat ~16g

Iron ~12mg

Vit C: tomato+drum

OPTION 2

All phases · classic Telugu

Brown rice + gongura pappu + egg curry

¾ cup cooked brown rice
+ gongura (sorrel leaves) pappu with ghee
+ 2-egg curry with onion, tomato, spices
+ roasted brinjal on the side · yogurt after

Protein ~30g

Carbs ~60g

Fat ~18g

Iron ~11mg

Vit C: tomato+gong

OPTION 3

Follicular · lighter + fresh

Jowar roti + rajma curry + spinach stir-fry

2 jowar rotis
+ rajma (red kidney bean) curry with tomato, cumin
+ palak/spinach stir-fry with garlic, lemon
+ cucumber-tomato salad · yogurt after

Protein ~27g

Carbs ~62g

Fat ~14g

Iron ~11mg

Vit C: lemon+tomato

OPTION 4

Luteal · high protein + magnesium

Bajra roti + chana dal + methi sabzi

2 bajra (pearl millet) rotis
+ chana dal tadka with ghee, cumin, hing
+ methi (fenugreek) sabzi with onion, tomato
+ pumpkin seeds raita (yogurt base) · lemon squeeze

Protein ~26g

Carbs ~57g

Fat ~17g

Iron ~12mg

Vit C: lemon+tomato

OPTION 5

All phases · protein-heavy

Brown rice + 2-egg curry + beans palya

¾ cup brown rice
+ 2-egg curry (Chettinad-style or simple)
+ cluster beans (goru chikkudu) stir-fry with coconut
+ tomato rasam · yogurt after

Protein ~30g

Carbs ~59g

Fat ~17g

Iron ~10mg

Vit C: tomato rasam

OPTION 6

Ovulation · anti-inflammatory

Samai rice + moong dal + drumstick koora

¾ cup samai (little millet) cooked rice
+ moong dal with turmeric, ghee, curry leaves
+ drumstick (murungakkai) sabzi with coconut
+ lemon pickle · yogurt after

Protein ~25g

Carbs ~56g

Fat ~15g

Iron ~9mg

Vit C: drumstick+lime

OPTION 7

All phases · Sunday special

Full Telugu thali (balanced)

Brown rice + ragi sangati (small)

+ pappu (any dal) + sambar + 1 koora + rasam

+ appadalu + nuvvula pachadi (sesame chutney)

+ 1 tsp ghee · yogurt after

Protein ~26g

Carbs ~65g

Fat ~18g

Iron ~11mg

Vit C: rasam+tomato

Dinner Options

Dinner is lighter — 380–450 kcal. You eat at 7:30pm and are done by 8:30pm, which gives 12+ hrs before breakfast. Keep carbs lower here than lunch. Easy to pack and reheat at work. High protein to prevent muscle loss overnight. Still include iron + Vit C pairing.

OPTION 1

All phases · easiest to pack

Jowar roti + methi dal + cucumber raita

2 jowar rotis
+ methi (fenugreek) dal with cumin, ghee
+ cucumber + yogurt raita
+ lemon squeeze on dal

Protein ~22g Carbs ~40g Fat ~12g Iron ~7mg

Vit C: lemon+methi

OPTION 2

All phases · high protein

Egg curry + 2 rotis + tomato salad

2 boiled-egg curry (onion-tomato base, minimal oil)
+ 2 small wheat or jowar rotis
+ tomato + onion + lemon salad
+ small portion yogurt (separately)

Protein ~26g Carbs ~38g Fat ~14g Iron ~6.5mg

Vit C: tomato+lemon

OPTION 3

All phases · one-pot meal

Millet khichdi + yogurt

Bajra or samai khichdi with moong dal, carrot, beans, cumin, ghee
+ roasted papad
+ lemon pickle
+ small bowl yogurt (end of meal)

Protein ~20g Carbs ~44g Fat ~12g Iron ~6mg

Vit C: lemon pickle

OPTION 4

Menstruation · warming + iron

Palak dal + brown rice + sesame

½ cup brown rice
+ palak (spinach) dal with garlic, cumin, ghee tadka
+ nuvula (sesame) chutney on the side
+ lemon squeeze · warm, comforting

Protein ~22g Carbs ~45g Fat ~14g Iron ~9mg

Vit C: lemon+tomato

OPTION 5

Follicular · light + fresh

Brown rice tomato bath + boiled egg

Brown rice tomato bath (tomato rice cooked with spices)
+ 1 boiled egg sliced on top
+ cucumber + carrot salad with lemon
+ small yogurt (end)

Protein ~21g Carbs ~42g Fat ~12g Iron ~5.5mg

Vit C: tomato+lemon

OPTION 6

Luteal · reduce carbs · satiating

Egg + vegetable stir-fry + 1 roti

2-egg stir-fry with capsicum, beans, carrot, turmeric, pepper
+ 1 jowar or wheat roti
+ small bowl of dal or rasam
+ yogurt raita end

Protein ~24g Carbs ~32g Fat ~15g Iron ~5mg

OPTION 7

All phases · festival option

Samai pulao + rajma + raita

Little millet pulao with vegetables (no egg needed)

+ rajma (kidney bean) curry — iron + protein

+ onion-tomato-cucumber raita

+ lemon on rajma

Protein ~22g

Carbs ~42g

Fat ~11g

Iron ~8mg

Vit C: tomato+lemon

Morning Drinks + Snacks

Morning drinks are taken immediately on waking (before breakfast). They prep your gut, activate digestion, and for PCOS, help with cortisol and blood sugar before your first meal. Choose one drink per day and rotate.

Morning drinks · on waking, before breakfast

All phases · everyday

Warm lemon water

Juice of ½ lemon in 200ml warm water. No sugar. Drink within 5 min of waking.

Vit C primes iron absorption for breakfast · wakes digestion · mild cortisol balancer · PCOS-friendly daily ritual

All phases · insulin support

Jeera (cumin) water

1 tsp cumin seeds soaked in 250ml water overnight. Strain and drink warm in the morning.

Reduces fasting blood sugar · improves insulin sensitivity · anti-inflammatory · good for bloating which worsens pre-period

Menstruation · period cramps

Ajwain + ginger water

½ tsp ajwain (carom seeds) + 1-inch ginger piece boiled in 300ml water for 5 min. Strain, sip warm.

Relieves menstrual cramps and bloating · warming and anti-spasmodic · reduces nausea during periods

Follicular · hormone support

Spearmint tea

1 tsp dried spearmint (pudina) leaves steeped in 250ml hot water for 5 min. Drink plain.

Has evidence for reducing free testosterone in PCOS · anti-androgenic effect · reduces hirsutism mildly over time · 2 cups/day

Luteal · anxiety + sleep prep

Ashwagandha warm water

¼ tsp ashwagandha powder in 200ml warm water. Or buy KSM-66 capsules (consult doctor first).

Adaptogen — lowers cortisol, reduces luteal-phase anxiety and mood swings · also mildly improves insulin sensitivity

All phases · gut health

Amla juice (fresh or concentrate)

30ml fresh amla juice or 1 amla blended with 150ml water. No sugar. Can add ¼ tsp turmeric.

Highest natural Vit C source — dramatically boosts iron absorption · antioxidant · improves gut motility · PCOS anti-inflammatory

All phases · detox + digestion

Methi (fenugreek) seed water

1 tsp methi seeds soaked in 250ml water overnight. Drink the water (seeds optional to chew).

Clinically shown to reduce fasting blood sugar and improve insulin sensitivity in PCOS · also a good iron source

*Morning nuts + seeds · have with or just after breakfast***Daily · soak overnight****Soaked almonds (6–8)**

Soak 6–8 almonds in water overnight. Peel skin in the morning. Eat slowly.

Soaking removes phytic acid (anti-nutrient that blocks iron). Provides healthy fat, Vit E, magnesium — all beneficial for PCOS and anxiety

Luteal · magnesium · daily**Pumpkin seeds (1 tbsp)**

1 tbsp raw or lightly roasted pumpkin seeds. No salt. Can mix into oats or eat separately.

Highest magnesium source — directly reduces PMS, cramps, anxiety, and poor sleep. Also provides zinc for PCOS hormone balance.

Daily · iron + omega-3**Flaxseeds (1 tbsp ground)**

1 tbsp freshly ground flaxseed (grind weekly, store in fridge) stirred into oats or water.

Lignans in flaxseed help regulate oestrogen and reduce androgen activity in PCOS. Omega-3 reduces inflammation. Prevents constipation (critical with iron supplements).

Follicular + ovulation · phase seed cycling**Sesame seeds (nurvulu) 1 tbsp**

1 tbsp sesame seeds — raw, roasted, or as chutney. Can mix into oats or sprinkle on food.

High iron (1.3mg/tbsp) + calcium + zinc. Lignans support progesterone in follicular phase. Part of seed cycling protocol for PCOS hormone regulation.

Menstruation · iron burst**Sprouted methi seeds**

Soak 1 tbsp methi seeds 8 hrs, drain and sprout for 12 hrs. Eat with lemon + salt.

Sprouting increases iron bioavailability significantly. Methi also relieves period cramps and reduces blood sugar spikes during the heavier flow days.

Daily · protein + iron**Sprouted green moong (2–3 tbsp)**

Soak moong overnight, drain, sprout for 8–10 hrs at room temp. Eat plain or with lemon + cumin.

Sprouting doubles protein digestibility and increases iron bioavailability. Excellent egg substitute on festival days. Very low GI — no insulin spike.

Cycle Alignment

With PCOS your cycle may be irregular (often 35–45+ days). These phases still apply but their timing shifts. Use your cycle tracking app to identify which phase you're in, then apply the relevant food shifts. The changes are not dramatic — your base diet stays the same. These are targeted adjustments.

Phase 1 — Menstruation

Day 1–5 (or whenever your period is active)

Body is losing blood and iron rapidly. Energy is lower. Prostaglandins cause cramps. Digestion slows.

Prioritise

- Maximum iron: ragi sangati, palak pappu, gongura, sesame — every meal
- Vit C with every iron source — amla, lemon, tomato. More than usual.
- Warming foods: ajwain water, ginger, turmeric, jeera — reduces cramps
- Magnesium: pumpkin seeds, dark leafy greens — reduces cramp severity
- Omega-3: flaxseeds daily — anti-inflammatory, reduces prostaglandins

Avoid or reduce

- Salty, spicy, processed foods — worsen bloating and cramps
- Caffeine — raises cortisol and worsens cramps
- Dairy-heavy meals — calcium blocks iron when you need it most

Phase 2 — Follicular

Day 6–13 (post-period, pre-ovulation)

Oestrogen is rising. Energy, mood, and metabolism improve. Best phase for physical challenges and trying new things. Digestion is stronger.

Prioritise

- Fresh, lighter meals — your digestion handles them best now
- Spearmint tea (2 cups) — most effective in this phase for androgen reduction
- Seed cycling: flaxseeds + pumpkin seeds (support oestrogen metabolism)
- Sprouted foods — moong, methi sprouts. Higher enzyme activity benefits you.
- Fermented foods: idli, dosa batter, yogurt — best gut phase

Good time for

- Heavier strength workouts — energy is higher, recovery is faster
- Trying new meals and recipes — appetite and digestion are optimal

Phase 3 — Ovulation

Day 14–16 (roughly mid-cycle — may vary with PCOS)

Peak oestrogen. Highest energy and confidence. Inflammation is naturally lower. Short window — 1–3 days. With PCOS, ovulation may be delayed or irregular.

Prioritise

- Anti-inflammatory foods: turmeric, ginger, flaxseed, leafy greens
- Zinc-rich foods: pumpkin seeds, sesame, legumes — supports ovulation
- Light, fresh meals — raw salads are fine here if digestion is strong
- Fibre: helps clear excess oestrogen via the gut before luteal phase

Avoid

- Sugar and refined carbs — can dampen ovulation quality in PCOS
- Alcohol or excessive caffeine — interfere with LH surge timing

Phase 4 — Luteal

Day 17–28 (or until period starts — longest phase)

Progesterone rises. Energy dips in the second half. PMS symptoms peak: bloating, cravings, mood swings, anxiety spikes, food cravings. PCOS worsens these.

Prioritise

- Higher protein at every meal — reduces cravings and stabilises blood sugar
- Magnesium daily: pumpkin seeds, palak, almonds — reduces cramps + anxiety
- Vitamin B6: chickpeas, eggs, bananas (paired) — reduces PMS mood swings
- Seed cycling switch: sesame + sunflower seeds (support progesterone)
- Complex carbs only — cravings are real; meet them with ragi laddoo, roasted chana, not biscuits
- Ashwagandha water — most beneficial in this phase for cortisol + anxiety

Reduce

- Salt — worsens bloating dramatically in this phase
- Total carbs slightly — insulin resistance peaks in luteal phase for PCOS
- Sugar cravings: replace with jaggery + nuts, not sweets or chocolate

Seed cycling for PCOS: A simple evidence-light but widely used hormonal support practice. Phase 1+2 (follicular): 1 tbsp flaxseeds + 1 tbsp pumpkin seeds daily. Phase 3+4 (luteal): 1 tbsp sesame seeds + 1 tbsp sunflower seeds daily. Easy to add to overnight oats. Takes 3+ cycles to notice any effect — consistency matters more than perfection.